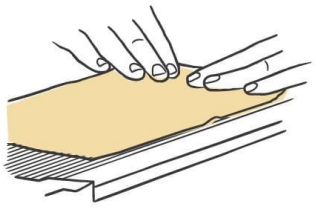
SPAGHETTI ALLA CHITARRA

REGION	REST
Abruzzo, where it goes by maccheroni alla chitarra, spaghetti alla chitarra, and pasta alla chitarra; Lazio, as tonnarelli	**20 to 30 minutes at room temperature**

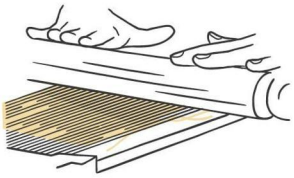
METHOD

1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden cutting board lightly with 00 flour. Set out a parchment-lined sheet pan, dusted lightly with semolina.
3. Lay the sheets on the board and cut them into 8 by 9-inch rectangles, trimming off the ragged edges. Save the trim for soup. Keep the rectangles under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Take one rectangle and dust both faces with 00 flour. A chitarra is strung on both sides at two different string spacings — use the narrower side. Lay the sheet over the wires and run a rolling pin back and forth over it, bearing down until the wires cut all the way through. This takes more force than you would expect.
5. Gather the strands, dust them generously with 00 flour, shake them apart, curl the batch into a nest, and set it on the pan.
6. Repeat with the remaining rectangles.
7. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature. To hold, wrap the pan and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



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NOTES

Requires a chitarra — a tabletop frame strung with fine metal wires, shaped more like a harp than the guitar it is named for, with a collection box beneath. The two faces carry wires at different spacings; this shape uses the narrower one.
Sheets are rolled thicker than usual: 1/8 inch rather than the typical 1/16 inch.
Sheets cut to 8 by 9 inches before going over the wires.
Yields square-sided strands with a springy texture.
One portion at a time is all the tool will do, which is why much of the Abruzzese version is machine-made today.
Keeps refrigerated up to 24 hours.
Interchangeable with spaghetti. Traditionally paired with lamb, either in small meatballs in tomato sauce or as ragù, and with zucchini cooked with saffron.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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